CLARA ALAGY

PhD Candidate in Collective Action and Environment

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LANGUAGES

French (native), English (full professional proficiency), Greek (conversational), German (beginner), Spanish (beginner)

EDUCATION

Institut National de la Recherche Scientifique, Collective Action and Environment, Montréal, Canada **2024–**
PhD: "Between Citizen Initiatives and Municipal Public Authorities: Citizen Contributions and Gender Issues in the Transition to a Circular Economy."
Supervised by Sophie L. Van Neste, Professor at the INRS Urbanisation Culture Société Research Centre.
Co-supervised by Sophie Bernard, Professor in the Department of Mathematics and Industrial Engineering at Polytechnique Montréal.

Polytechnique Montréal, Industrial Engineering, Montréal, Québec, Canada **2021–2023**
Research Master's: "Characterizing Circular Jobs and Their Quality in Québec's Social and Circular Economy."
Supervised by Sophie Bernard, Full Professor in the Department of Mathematics and Industrial Engineering at Polytechnique Montréal.
Co-supervised by Emmanuel B. Raufflet, Full Professor in the Department of Management at HEC Montréal.
Thesis nominated by the jury for Polytechnique Montréal's 2023 Best Master's Thesis Award

École Nationale Supérieure de Génie Industriel, Grenoble, France **2019–2021**
Engineering Degree (professional master's equivalent) in Industrial Engineering, specialization in Supply Chain Engineering
Systems analysis and flow modelling, information systems management, operations research, economics, sociology, human resources management, object-oriented algorithmic modelling, etc.

Cycle Préparatoire Polytechnique, Grenoble, France **2017–2019**
Preparatory program for engineering schools.

Lycée Notre-Dame de Bellegarde, Lyon, France **2017**
French Baccalauréat in Science, specialization in Mathematics, highest honours (Très Bien).

SCHOLARSHIPS, AWARDS AND CERTIFICATIONS

Rio Tinto Scholarship for Diversity in Science – $15,000 **2026**

Scotiabank Observatory on Sustainable Development Innovation Doctoral Scholarship – $20,000 **2026**

INRS Sustainability Project Continuity Grant – $7,000 **2026**
Grant awarded to support the long-term sustainability of the UCS Nid-de-Poule bicycle workshop.

INRS Universal Doctoral Scholarship – $5,000 **2025**

INRS Specialization Grant for Sophie Van Neste's research team – $10,000 **2025**

CRISES (Centre de recherche sur les innovations sociales), Territories and Living Environments Research Axis Scholarship – $2,000 **2025**

RRECQ (Québec Circular Economy Research Network) Discovery Grant – $15,000 **2022**
Funding awarded for the research project "Characterizing Circular Jobs and Their Quality in Québec's Social and Solidarity Economy."

CIRODD (Interdisciplinary Research Centre on the Operationalization of Sustainable Development) Exploration Grant – $11,500 **2022**
Funding awarded for the research project "Characterizing Circular Jobs and Their Quality in Québec's Social and Solidarity Economy."

Mitacs Accelerate Grant – $10,000 **2022**
Mitacs grant in partnership with TIESS (Territoires innovants en économie sociale et solidaire), a knowledge-transfer organization connecting Québec's social and solidarity economy sector with academic research.

Research Ethics Training Certificate, Montréal, Canada **2022**
Tri-Council Policy Statement: Ethical Conduct for Research Involving Humans (TCPS 2: CORE 2022) research ethics training.

TOEFL iBT, Educational Testing Service (ETS) **2020**
Score: 107/120. Advanced in Speaking, Listening, and Reading; High in Writing.

Linguaskill, Cambridge Assessment, English **2020**
Score: 180+, equivalent to CEFR level C1+.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed

Alagy, C., Bernard, S., & Raufflet, E. (2026). Examining Job Satisfaction in the Social and Solidarity Circular Economy. Journal of Circular Economy, 4(1). https://doi.org/10.55845/joce-2026–4144

Conference proceedings

Alagy, C., Bernard, S., Raufflet E. The Quality of Circular Jobs in the Social and Solidarity Economy. Interdisciplinary Circular Economy Conference - CIEC 2024, University of Toulouse [UT], Jun 2024, Montpellier, France. hal-04815543

Research reports

Heck, I., Alagy, C., Arnaud, J. (2026). Summary of the 2025 Learning Forum. Projet Impact Collectif, Centraide. [En ligne]

Heck, I., Arnaud, J., Alagy, C. (2026). PIC in Motion: Lessons from Phase 2. Mid-Term Review. Projet Impact Collectif, Centraide. [En ligne]

Alagy, C. (2024). Best Practices for Improving Equity, Diversity and Inclusion in Interdisciplinary Teamwork. Québec Circular Economy Research Network (RRECQ)

Arnaud, J., Heck, I., Alagy, C. (2024). Summary of the 2024 Learning Forum. Projet Impact Collectif, Centraide. [En ligne]

Public scholarship

Alagy, C. (2026). Thematic Feature: Care, Citizens, and the City: Rethinking Relationships in Urban Contexts. Villes, Régions, Monde (VRM). [En ligne]

Ballon, J., El-Amraoui A., Alagy, C. (2024). Summary of the Pop-up University on Democratic and Participatory Governance in the Social and Circular Economy, HEC Montréal. [En ligne]

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

Alagy, C. (2026). Urban Collective Action in the Socio-Ecological Transition. Choosing the Transition Summer School. Université de Montréal, Canada

Alagy, C., Van Neste, S., Bernard, S. (2026). A Care Ethics Approach to the Circular Transition: Addressing the Contradictions of the Circular Economy Through Practices of Care. Circular Economy - Interdisciplinary Conference (CEIC 2026). Toulouse, France

Alagy, C. (2026). Roundtable "Living Differently: (Co-)constructing Relationships to the Intimate and the Collective". CELAT International Conference 2026. Québec, Canada

Alagy, C. (2026). Rethinking Circularity Through the Lens of Care: Contributions of Care Ethics to the Circular Transition. ACFAS 2026, Trois-Rivières, Canada

Alagy, C., Bernard, S., Van Neste, S. (2025). Grassroots Socio-Ecological Transition Initiatives: What Place in the Transition to a Circular Economy? ACFAS 2025, Montréal, Canada

Alagy, C. (2025). Reshaping the relationship to neighbourhoods and the habitat : the role of grassroots transition initiatives in the city, Urban affairs association conference 2025, Vancouver, Canada

Alagy, C. (2024). The Landscape of Circular Employment in Québec Social Economy Enterprises. BistroBrain x RRECQ, Montréal, Canada.

Alagy, C. Bernard, S., Raufflet E. (2024). Job and Work Quality in the Circular Economy: Is the Social Economy an Ally? Interdisciplinary Circular Economy Conference, Montpellier, France

Alagy, C., Bernard, S., Raufflet, E. (2024). Organizational Practices and Job Satisfaction in the Social and Circular Economy. Pop-up University on Democratic and Participatory Governance in the Social and Circular Economy, HEC Montréal, Canada

Alagy, C. Bernard, S., Raufflet E. (2023). Jobs in Québec's Social and Circular Economy, ACFAS 2023, Montréal, Canada.

PROFESSIONAL AND ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Research assistantships

Research Assistant **Since September 2025**
Projet international « Social economy embedding circular economy: theory, practice and potential »
Supervised by Rafael Ziegler (HEC Montréal) et Julie Rijpens (UQAM)
Contribution: review of national, regional, and municipal circular economy public policies related to the social economy (150 h)

Research Assistant and Coordination Support **Since April 2025**
Projet « Économie sociale et gouvernance territoriale : quels rôles pour les méta-organisations d'économie sociale pour organiser des chaînes de valeur circulaires ? »
Supervised by Martine Vézina (HEC Montréal), Justine Ballon (HEC Montréal) et Julie Rijpens (UQAM)
Contribution: organization and conduct of interviews, transcription, and qualitative coding (4 h/semaine)

Research Assistant **May 2024**
Projet « Participatory Governance in the Social and Circular Economy »
Supervised by Martine Vezina (HEC Montréal)
Contribution: translation and meetings (12h).

Research Assistant **April–June 2024**
Projet « Pop-up University on Democratic and Participatory Governance in the Social and Circular Economy »
Supervised by Justine Ballon (HEC Montréal)
Contribution: Preparation of summaries based on notes from the October 2023 pop-up university; writing, editing, and formatting of the final deliverable (20h)

Research Assistant **December 2023–February 2024**
Projet « Work, Employment, Skills » - RRECQ (Québec Circular Economy Research Network) et CRIMT (Interuniversity Research Centre on Globalization and Work)
Supervised by Emmanuel Raufflet (HEC Montréal), Sara Pérez-Lauzon (HEC Montréal) et Vincent Pasquier (HEC Montréal)
Contribution: Development of a glossary on circular employment, work, and skills. Contribution to defining project priorities and research areas (35h).

Research Assistant and Coordinator **2022–2024**
Equity, Diversity and Inclusion (EDI) Committee - RRECQ (Québec Circular Economy Research Network, Montréal)
Contribution: participation in and organization of committee meetings; independent development of a survey for network members on their experiences of EDI; review of EDI training opportunities to expand the network's offerings; preparation of a report on best practices for collaborative work in interdisciplinary teams (8 h/semaine).

Mitacs Intern at TIESS (Territoires Innovants en Économie Sociale et Solidaire) **2022 – 2024**
Contribution: contributed to developing a directory of social and circular economy initiatives and participated in team meetings

Teaching experience

Teaching Assistant **2022**
Canadian Open Mathematics Challenge (COMC)
Supervised by Marc Laforest (Polytechnique Montréal)
Contribution: grading approximately 250 mathematics papers (35 h).

Professional experience

Social Media Manager, Villes, Régions, Monde (VRM) Research Network **Since 2026**
Supervised by Salomé Valette.
Contribution: management of the network's LinkedIn and Bluesky platforms (5h/semaine)

Research Associate **2024–2026**
Projet Impact Collectif (PIC) – Operated by Centraide
Supervised by Isabel Heck (Centraide/CRISES)
Contribution: regular meetings with Montréal neighbourhood roundtables, qualitative coding, qualitative data analysis, and research report writing (10 h/semaine)

Research Associate October–December **2024**
Climate Equity Lab
Supervised by Sophie L. Van Neste (INRS)
Contribution: review of climate equity tools, proposal of a dashboard for presenting them, and participation in team meetings (7 h/semaine)

Server, Microbrasserie Siboire Saint-Laurent, Montréal, Québec **2022**

Assistant Engineer Intern, Yusen Logistics France, Saint-Quentin-Fallavier, France June–August **2021**
Internship in Yusen Logistics' Solution Design Business Unit. Project: optimization of intralogistics processes and Kaizen. Optimized inventory storage through data analysis and capacity sizing, then implemented storage rules. Formalized processes, assessed optimization profitability, and drafted SOPs. Provided ad hoc logistics support, including automating repetitive tasks with VBA macros (Microsoft Excel), creating project tracking sheets, and modelling processes.

Sales Associate, Boulangerie et café Maison Jocteur, Lyon, France **Summers 2018–2021**

Woodworking Shop Intern, Menuiserie du Dauphiné, Échirolles, France **May–June 2019**

Relevant academic service

Member of the CRISES EDI (Equity, Diversity and Inclusion) Committee (Centre for Research on Social Innovations) **Since June 2025**

Student Member of CAPED (Collectif de recherche action politique et démocratie). **Since Sept. 2024**
Member of the CAPED student committee: committee coordination; organization and planning of events; implementation of initiatives supporting student success within CAPED.

Member of the CIRCULAR Working Group **Since 2024**
Student circular economy working group affiliated with Université Grenoble Alpes. Collaborative meetings and work among PhD students on circular industrial production systems.

Member of RRECQ (Québec Circular Economy Research Network) **Since 2023**
Member of the expert committees for workstreams B3 (Circular Economy Practices in Organizations) and E2 (Rebound Effects of Circular Economy Initiatives). Member of the steering committee for workstream D3 (Work, Employment and Skills in the Circular Economy).

Research projects

Field Study for Demand2Plan, Les Abrets-En-Dauphiné, France January–May 2021
Field study: "Industrializing Digital Twin Design to Secure Customer Service and Streamline Production and Distribution" for Demand2Plan, an industrial engineering consulting firm specializing in the industrialization of processes, teams, and systems.
Conducted a literature review on digital twins and their application in Industry 4.0
Studied the stages involved in implementing a digital twin in a medium-sized company
Created a toolkit to facilitate digital twin implementation across different types of organizations

Bachelor's Capstone Project, Restaurant Universitaire du Crous, Grenoble, France January–May 2020
Project on "Waste Management and Reduction in a University Restaurant." Commended by the jury for its quality.
Studied the food waste management system
Reviewed methods for reducing consumer waste
Developed a student awareness campaign on the consequences of waste

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT AND VOLUNTEERING

Co-coordinator, "Calendrier des mécanos" Project – BUM Coalition **2026**
The calendar project raises funds for the Bécyk Unis de Montréal (BUM) coalition and Montréal community bicycle workshops. Co-led the annual calendar project: coordination, photo shoot organization, model recruitment, editing, publication, etc.

Co-founder and Coordinator of the INRS LGBTQ+ Committee **Since 2025**
Co-founded the LGBTQ+ committee. Organized social activities and awareness initiatives on LGBTQ+ realities in academia. Collaborated with the INRS EDI Committee on a multimedia awareness campaign.

Volunteer and Coordinator, Nid-de-Poule Bicycle Workshop **Since March 2025**
Bicycle repair, knowledge sharing, liaison with other community bicycle-repair organizations, and development of the committee within and beyond INRS. Advocacy for active and sustainable mobility within and beyond INRS.

Co-founder of Queer of Clubs **2025**
LGBTQ+ community card-game club. Organized and facilitated twice-monthly gatherings.

Member of the Ker-Mess Artists' Collective **Since 2024**
Arts and production collective involved in Lespacemaker's annual fundraising campaign, a community creative fab lab in Hochelaga. Built structures for events.

Volunteer at Maison d'Aurore, Montréal, QC **2022–2023**
Provided twice-weekly homework support to an elementary school student and developed learning tools adapted to the student's needs.

Member of the Collages Féministes activist groups in Lyon and Grenoble. **2020–2022**
Organized and coordinated meetings and mobilizations; participated in direct activist actions.

Member of the Sustainable Development Committee, Grenoble INP **2021**
Participated in meetings, developed waste-sorting awareness posters for the school, and organized community clean-up walks.

Secretary and Equity, Diversity and Inclusion Officer, Student Committee, Grenoble INP **2020 – 2021**
Participated in meetings and executive decision-making; coordinated school committees; organized events in compliance with COVID-19 health regulations; developed and maintained relationships with partners and sponsors; advised on equity, diversity and inclusion, promoting respectful and inclusive practices and proposing solutions adapted to the student context.

Treasurer, Solidaire Game Kove Project, Association Solida'rire, Grenoble INP **2019 – 2020**
Solidarity project providing academic support to children aged 6–14 in Game Kove, Togo.

Managed the Game Kove project budget, organized fundraising initiatives, and prepared grant applications.

Sponsorship Officer, Student Committee, Cycle Préparatoire Polytechnique **2017 – 2019**
Organized student events and secured financial partners and sponsors.

Treasurer, Terre Citoyenne et Solidaire Humanitarian Association, Notre-Dame de Bellegarde, Lyon **2015–2017**
Val de Saône association carrying out projects in the Lomé region of Togo.

Managed the finances of Terre Citoyenne et Solidaire and contributed to projects including construction of a school cafeteria, a borehole, and a classroom; organized fundraising activities within and outside the school; organized weekly meetings and participated in general assemblies.